



ZERO RUPEE MARKETING

BUSTING MYTHS AROUND GUERRILLA MARKETING

SAKTHIVEL PANNERSELVAM

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**BUSTING MYTHS AROUND
GUERRILLA MARKETING**

Sakthivel Pannerselvam

Zero Rupee Marketing
Busting Myths around Guerrilla Marketing - Business Development
© Sakthivel Pannerselvam
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Dedication

My Amma & Appa
They sacrificed everything just to educate me

Bhuvana, my wife.
Without her I would have not done
what I have done today

Laya & Sharaan, my kids.
My partners in crime

Thanks

Mr. Pravin Sekar

He insisted me that I should write a book
whenever I met him.

My fellow entrepreneurs from Start-up Karam,
who always encourage me in my new initiatives.

My colleagues at the6.in,
who gave me the time & freedom to focus on the book.

Mano Bharathi & his team from Spellink Mistake,
for doing an awesome work with this book.

Dhivya Balaji

Editor, Author & Content Writer
Founder, Precis Penning Literary Services.

&

Covid-19,
for speeding up the process of the book
because of the lockdown.

Sakthivel Pannerselvam

Entrepreneur - Guerrilla Marketer - Influencer - Speaker

He is the Founder and Chief Surprise Ninja of 'the6.in', the pioneers in Surprise planning. He's also the Chief Happiness Officer at HappyO, a brand created to celebrate birthday parties at home. He is the Chief Marketing Officer of Drums Circle, a company run by his son, Sharaan. He has also done successful Guerrilla Marketing experiments with brands like Red Bus, Thalapakati, Viveks India, BPCL & so on.

Curating unique experiences is his vision and spreading happiness is his mission. Sakthi got featured in many prominent magazines and dailies including Outlook Magazine, BBC, The Hindu, Times of India & so on.

The story of Surprise Planning got featured in many TV Channels including Vijay TV, Sun TV, News 7, Thanthi TV, News 18 & so on.



AWARDS

- 'Young & Innovative Excellence' Award
IVUP, Bangalore
- 'Cheerleader For Change' Award
Thenmozhi Trust
- Visionary Award for cause
WEDO



SPEAKS ON

- Guerrilla Marketing
- Power of Moments
- Journey as the son of a mill worker towards being a successful Entrepreneur.

DO IT. DO IT NOW.

I am Pravin Shekar, an Outlier Marketer, and it is my pleasure to write the foreword for Sakthi's book. As a fellow marketer, I have been observing his ideas and execution, which are clearly out of the ordinary.

Look at this situation. Everything else has failed. The traditional methods have failed to bring in the desired results. That is when entrepreneurs "think" about doing something different. This thought though dies an early death in 95% of the cases. Frustration sets in, which leads to desperation and a fall into a victim mentality.

The 5% who dare to try out new things, get noticed and do see a bump in awareness and in business.

For you to be a good marketer, you must try out unconventional strategies and tactics. That is what differentiates a good entrepreneur from a great one. The ability to take that risk and go ahead and get it done, isn't that entrepreneurship?

A creative mind needs a fertile ground. This is only provided by like-minded entrepreneurs who chip in with support. An unconventional marketer surrounds him/herself with unlike minds. This cross-pollination leads to ideas that some people will laugh at, some will scoff at. A large segment though will wonder how this idea came about and how this non-traditional move is bringing in so much awareness and leads.

Keep wondering, as the world belongs to Doers. To those who dare and convert that daring to Doing. NOW.

The DOER does what is needed, gets things done. The DOER shows how it can be done, instead of stopping at ideation. Success lies in the execution. When you show and tell, it convinces your small, specific target segment. This provides an impetus for an Outlier Marketer to go forth and do more.

Sakthi is a DOER and that is why this book is a necessary addition to your library.

Going outside the norm, is the norm for an unconventional marketer.

A tribe builds around the marketer. One campaign at a time. One client at a time.

Playing on social behavior and rewarding people's generosity. Reusing waste material for social use. Using whatever is within and around to create awareness and grow business. All these are hallmarks of Guerrilla Outlier marketing. This has been demonstrated through live campaigns that Sakthi and his team have done.

You are of course, welcome to copy his ideas and use them in your campaign. That is the main purpose of this book, to spur your ideation. To help you get out of your comfort zone. To look at ideas that have worked, and adapt them for your own use. You cannot design a campaign to go viral. You can put in elements that get the buzz rolling. And it does roll. Read the examples which also list out the quantified ROI for the campaigns.

This book is coming out at the right time. Entrepreneurs are wondering about the future and what it holds in store. The Outlier marketer though is already planning and is in training. Training that will have a bunch of new services and newer campaigns. The DOER will be ready. As the smokescreen clears, the DOER will be the first off the start line, leading the WAY.

The world today needs Doers. To demystify the basics of marketing.
To think bigger and act smaller.
To keep inspiring people to do more.
To do more to add value and build trust.

That, is the bedrock of marketing.

My best wishes to Sakthi and his team to go on and execute a lot more Guerrilla / Outlier marketing campaigns.

A definite benefit to entrepreneurs and the marketing community.

Keep inspiring.

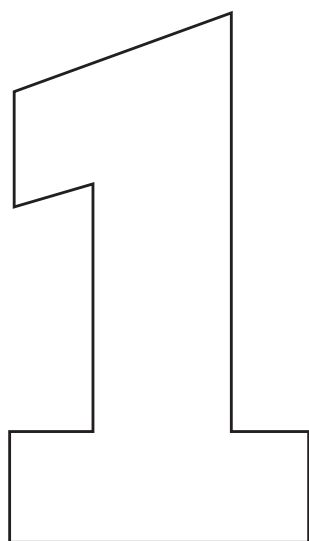
Pravin Shekar

Outlier Marketer

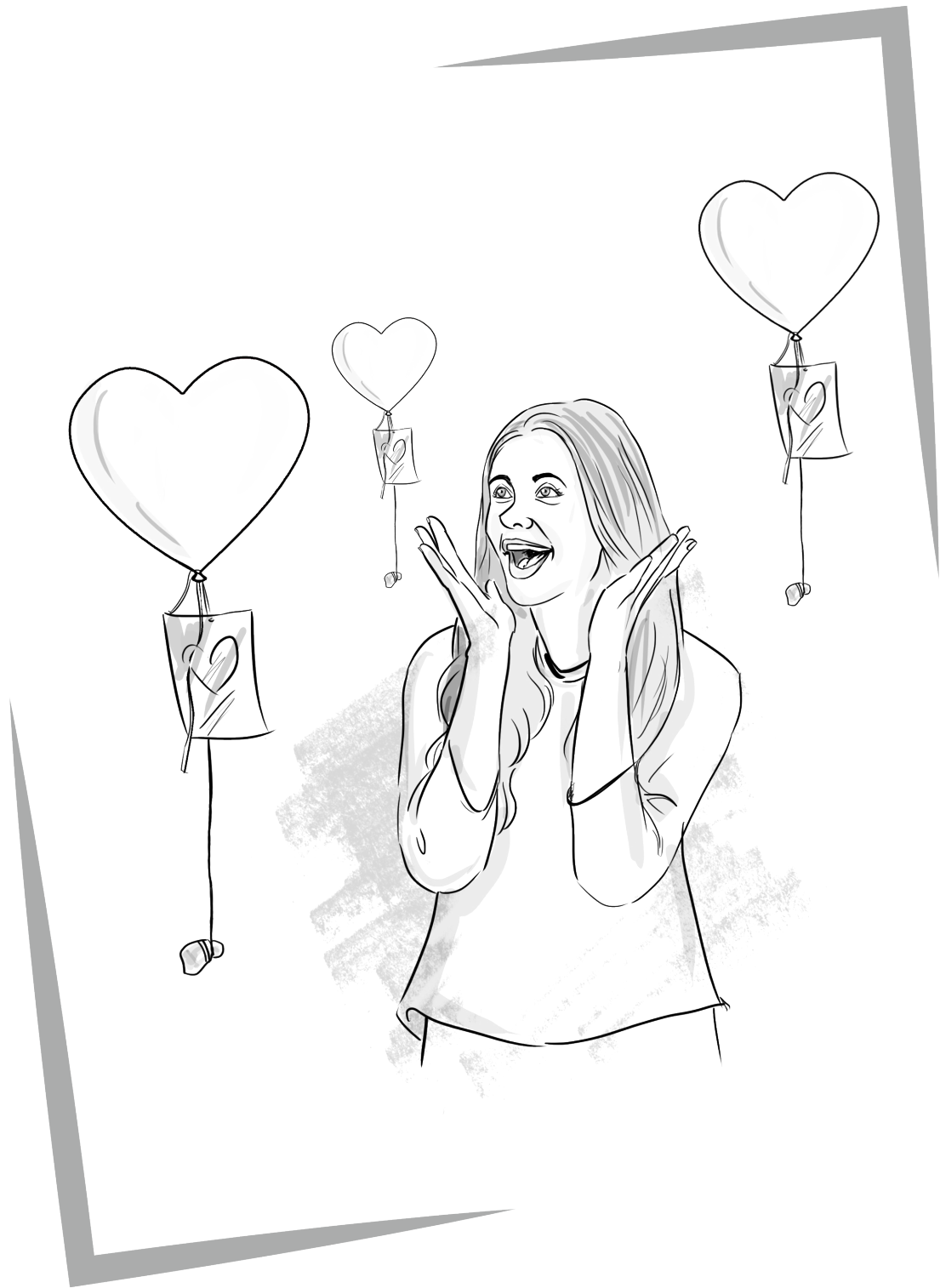
Author of 4 books

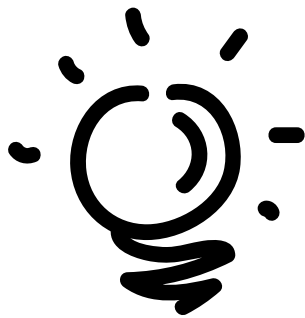
Raconteur

www.pravinshekar.com



**GAS BALLOONS, GIRLS,
GUERRILLA MARKETING**





MYTH #1 GUERRILLA MARKETING IS FOR BIG BRANDS

My first guerrilla marketing strategy was during Saraang - 2016, a cultural fest that happens in IIT Chennai.

It had been 4 months since I had quit my job. I had no salary for almost four months. December was the worst because of the Chennai floods.

I wanted to market the6.in to more people hence decided to have our stall in Saraang.

The stall for the 5-day festival itself was obtained in a unique way. The place, worth 40k, was bartered for the arrangement of flash mobs and traditional music troupe performances. We believed this would serve the dual purpose of taking our cultural identities in the art forms to one of the biggest platforms where they can be showcased, bringing these art forms recognition and making them popular amongst the impressionable young students. This was also cost-effective marketing, an effort to make our brand visible and memorable by other correlated events.

But on the day of the fest when we landed there, we were given a 4X4 square feet stall in a small corner beside the stage. Our stall was not even visible, and we could not even be heard over the noise from the speakers on stage, where other events were happening, taking the eyes away from our stall. So we had to think on our feet, and find some other effective technique using our marketers' brains.

To begin, we requested the organisers for a different location for our stall, and we shifted to a nearby place. Our competitor stalls were big names like the Times of India, MRF, and other businesses who had extravagant marketing inflow and thereby had better stalls placed in the prime areas. And they had events lined up with best of Emcees & giveaways and here I was, handing out flyers

For a small moment, it felt as if we were overshadowed by bigger brands with a better budget.

And then, our outlier marketing ideas kicked in, and we knew we would make the best out of it.

We decided to bombard the entire IIT campus with our brand. We called up the balloon seller Anna, asking if he could deliver 500 gas balloons at short notice. He arranged them for us at the best rate because we used his services regularly. We quickly had a colleague buy CD/OHP markers, and some nuts and bolts. We already had flyers advertising us ready in hand, to distribute to people who came to our stall. And we decided to use them uniquely.

AN IDEA WAS TAKING SHAPE

In a different attempt, we had 5 feet long balloon strings – we wanted our product to be visible to everyone. We tied a nut & bolt to the end of the string, so the balloons would not fly away. The metal weighed down the balloons and kept them floating instead of flying.

In a stellar cost-effective marketing idea, we placed the balloons tied with our flyers all over the campus. The floating balloons kept our flyers at eye level, making sure everyone noticed them. For an hour, from 2 PM – 3 PM, we dropped around 450 balloons in the campus, and at around 4 PM, most of the campus was actively reading our flyers.

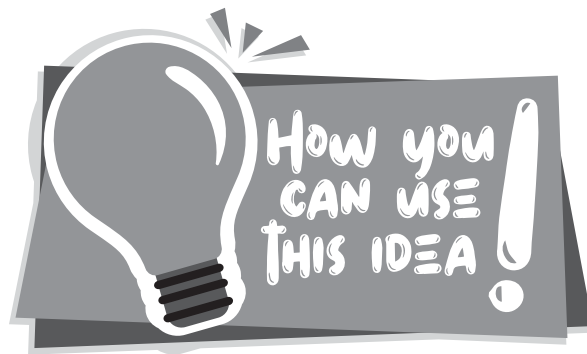
The girls were having our vibrant, brightly coloured, heart shaped gas balloons, and were reading our flyers. A crowd had been attracted, and the brand made visible. Within a short while, many people visited our stalls and started hearing out our surprise ideas.

What we had originally planned with stalls happened manifold better with our excellent Guerrilla Marketing idea.

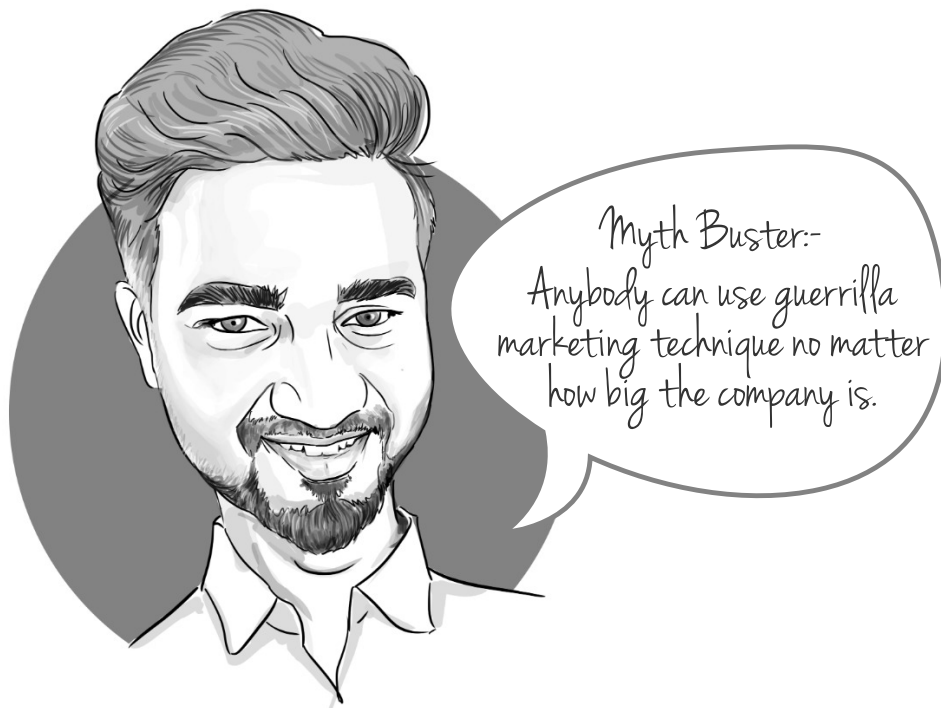
Students liked the innovative approach very much and even started carrying our balloons outside the campus, increasing visibility beyond the initial scope. Some friends from the Anna University noticed our balloons idea. They called us and appreciated our idea. Our brand marketing had expanded beyond the initially planned area.

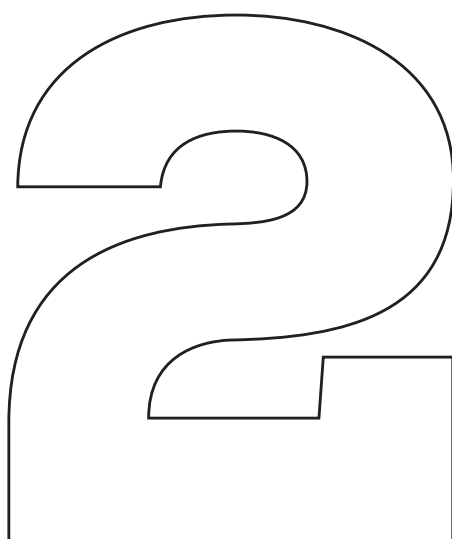
We were so happy that the6.in story had gotten its first reach via guerrilla marketing and we were able to compete with the bigger brands (and their increased better budget) at very low-cost marketing. We got two orders on the day we did this, and 20k leads with this marketing idea.

The promotions were also advertised on social media (not only from us but also those who loved the idea). The story and the unique idea were appreciated by everyone and it had an organic reach without any sponsored post shares.



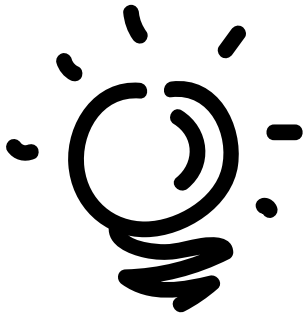
If you are participating in an expo,
what can you do differently to pull the
crowd at less cost ?





**SURPRISE NINJAS
DELIVERING
SURPRISE GIFTS**





MYTH #2

GUERRILLA

MARKETING

CAN'T BE USED

IN A TRADITIONAL

FESTIVAL SCENE

In 2017, when the farmers' protest was happening, we debated the idea of giving out traditional clothes to people living on the road sides. We chose veshtis, shirts, and sarees and then put together a 'Pongal Kit' with a difference.

One of the most important cornerstones of a successful guerrilla marketing campaign is the reach it has, both in a physical form and in the emotional connect. Unlike traditional marketing on print and visual media that basically advertise a product and its features/ importance, the cost effective outlier marketing encourages thinking out of the box.

What can be done to connect with the people's pulse?

The values that we are brought up with come in festivities, and the perennial celebrations that make us who we are. Each festival is our identity, for it showcases our culture and practices like no other medium. It was with this idea that we targeted Pongal, an important festival in Tamil Nadu, for an interesting marketing campaign

The kit consists of the dress set (as required for the men and women) along with sugarcane and rice, which are the standard requirements of the festival for people to make the essential sakkarapongal.

The twist here was this: Our Surprise Ninjas would go all over the city and deliver this kit to the people directly.

Our team went in search of Ninja costumes, and we got good ones from a costume rental place that suited our purpose. We also learnt the basic moves of ninjas to seem authentic, and got the 15+ Pongal kits ready in hand. Our enthusiastic team of guerrilla marketers dressed up as ninjas, and performed some amazing ninja moves too. We did somersaults, jumped about, did cartwheels and other interesting ninja moves, drawing the attention of the crowd.

We selected bus drivers, auto annas, roadside vendors, food cart vendors, and other people from the general public for our outlier marketing venture, and our Surprise Ninjas delivered the Pongal kits complete with their elaborate ninja moves.

A lot of people watched this unique idea, and a few took videos of our presentation, interested in what we were doing. A few others chose to take selfies with us, for their part in our interesting marketing idea. This was just another way to create an interest, and people participated willingly, because they liked the concept and the delivery of the products even if they were not the recipients.

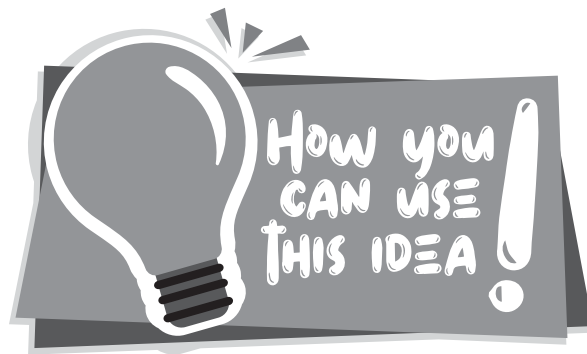
This is the power of a good idea. People's attentions are immediately captured by an idea if it is good enough.

Our intended recipients – those who got the Pongal kit from us – were also happy and the smiles on their faces made us happy too.

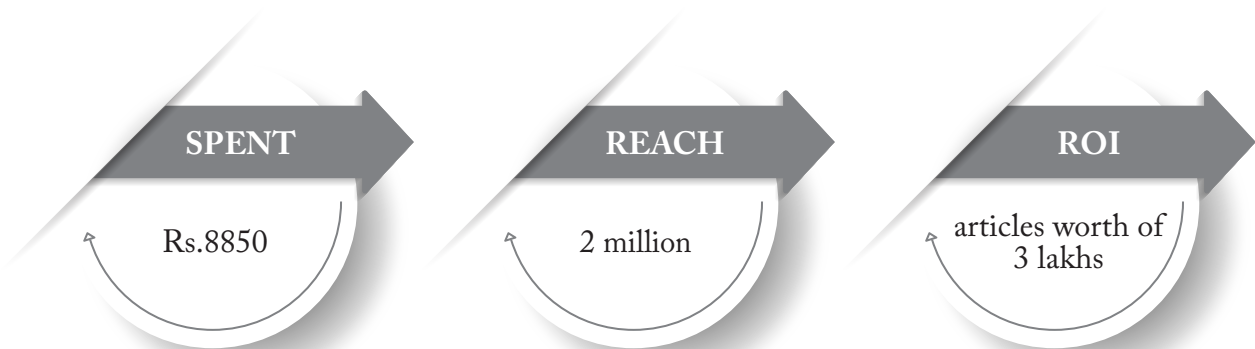
Guerrilla marketing examples often focus on spreading the cheer and positive feeling because this will retain the brand identity longer in the mind. If the marketing campaign made them smile and feel good, they associate the brand it represents with that same feeling, thereby making us more popular.

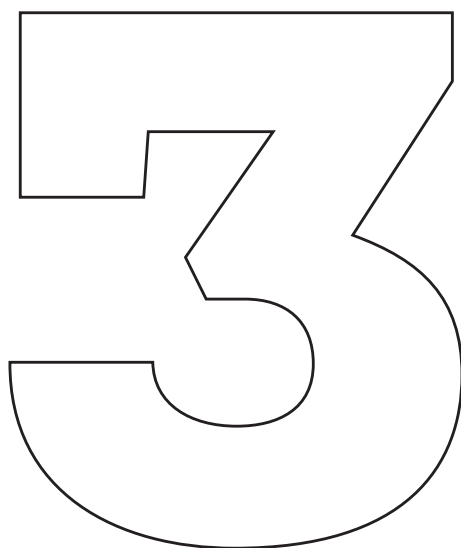
The general public also actively participated due to two reasons: the uniqueness of the idea, and the interesting presentation. The people who took videos and selfies with us were examples of our cost effective marketing campaign's success.

The story was shared widely on social media, and it created an emotional impact due to the way it touched the emotional chords of our tradition, and connected with people based on their cultural identities. The story was featured in DT Next and a radio station, who shared this along with the response we got for our interesting campaign.



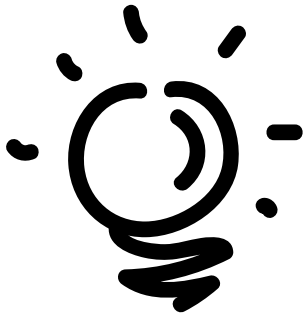
How do you integrate your brand with any day, say Women's Day , Valentine's Day, World Health Day & so on ?





HOW WE SPENT
RS.0/-
& BECAME VIRAL
ON SOCIAL MEDIA





MYTH #3

GUERRILLA

MARKETING IS

EXPENSIVE

Those who know the city of Chennai cannot miss the importance of its shopping district, Thyagaraya Nagar. And the most important part of this area is the Soundarapandianar Angadi – or the Pondy Bazaar. This market street that never sleeps, and within it one can find anything available in the commercial market.

It is in this area that we from the6.in got a chance to exhibit our marketing abilities.

The Corporation of Chennai and The Hindu collectively approached us for a unique concept of engaging people there for various activities that establish their efforts in the market street which is now a Smart Street as recognised by our Corporation bodies.

On a saturday, when the trial for Smart Street was on, we were performing flashmobs & dancing our heart out. A huge crowd gathered around us. People from the bus also started to record the mob. Our Guitarist & Singers started to play the best of the songs. We were now holding the attention of a massive crowd, that too in Pondy Bazaar,

Suddenly an idea struck my mind, why not a #MannequinChallenge. I approached people who gathered around us. Volunteers from schools & colleges agreed for the challenge. It took a little time for me to convince the employees of the shops. It was a decently numbered and everyone agreed.

The only challenge was no one should move until the video is complete. Since it is the general public & the traffic was moving we had to re take many a times. The ladies would talk sometimes, the men would adjust their hair. School kids would complain that someone changed the position. It took almost 45 minutes for us to take a video with no one moving.

The people of Pondy Bazaar stood as mannequins. More than 65 people were part of a huge chain and stood with different poses as mannequins. The active participation was a boost and encouragement to us, because we could bring the novelty of an international concept on a local level.

#MannequinChallenge was a worldwide popular phenomenon, gaining more traction with every passing day. Famous celebrities and even sports people were participating in this challenge and making it popular. Every video tagged under this hashtag had become part of a viral collection of videos..

The entire exercise did not cost us anything, and was the most cost effective outlier marketing idea. We only had our brains put to work, and with that we decided to try something unique that will get our name famous across platforms, and also send a message.

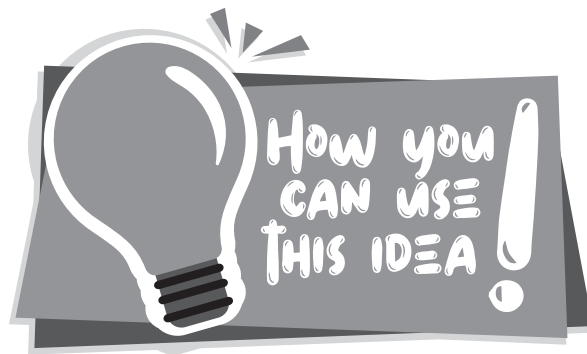
The guerrilla marketing was effective, and people noticed the unique ideas we had, associating it with our innovative marketing team.

On success of the mannequin challenge in Pondy Bazaar, we had an article written about it. For a zero cost venture with just brainstorming, we got a great amount of reach and brand recognition.

The mannequin challenge was an example of innovative methods reaching greater heights simply with proper planning and execution with zero monetary investments.

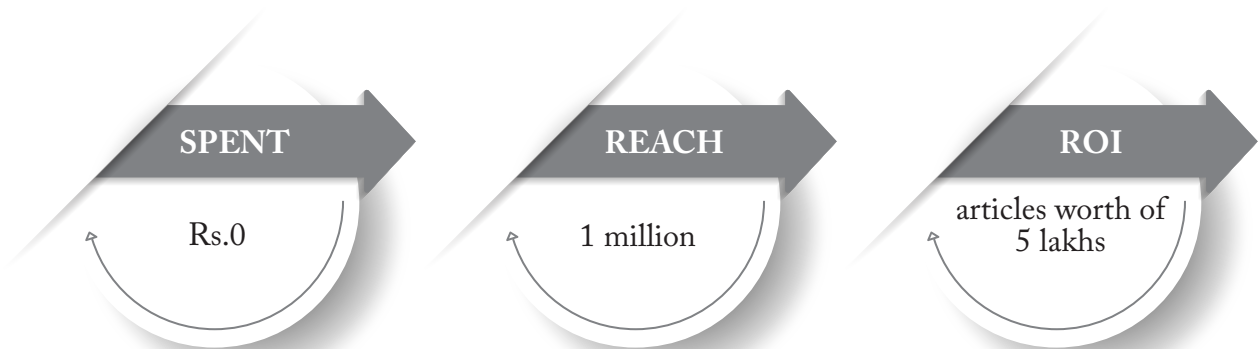
After this, the6.in became famous all over social media to the extent where other people attempted the same mannequin challenge we had popularised and tagged us in particular, making our name synonymous with the challenge.

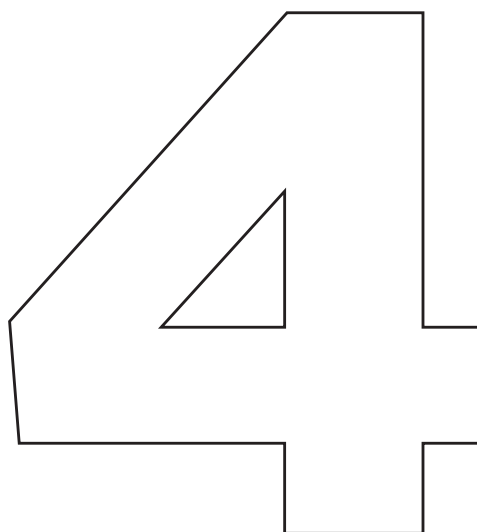
It is an appreciable venture that got the6.in a lot of recognition from Government bodies too, and the various teams involved were praised for their innovative approach to marketing. This attempt is a milestone one for us and it marked the effectiveness of creativity and out of the box thinking in marketing avenues.



Get inspired.

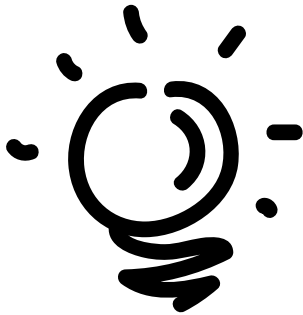
There may be many such unique ideas executed globally. You can use those techniques here and add local flavour to the concept.





HAPPY DOLL
VS
VOODOO DOLL
— A HAPPINESS CAMPAIGN





MYTH #4 GUERRILLA MARKETING NEEDS POSITIVE INSPIRATION

When the story of Stayzilla came out and I heard about the Voodoo doll.s, I was so upset. After the founder was arrested, many other start-up founders here in Chennai also conducted a meeting to discuss how to help him. What really hit us hard was the Voodoo doll and what happened to the kid.

He had been searching for a Voodoo doll just a few days back, in one of the shopping groups of which I was also a part. I am not sure what pushed me to go against this but my instincts wanted to challenge the negativity, and completely turn this over into a positive story.

I fixed a doll as a content.

I was The Hindu's (Young World) winner in of the events during my school days. I had created a cute doll back then. And now, I used all my learnings and created a new one. My team then simplified the process and optimised the costs.

And we were finally able to create the #HappyDoll.

We also designed a personalised thanking card along with the doll. The entire cost per unit was just Rs. 25/-.

I then picked my fellow entrepreneurs who have helped me in my business. A few of them were influencers themselves as well. I delivered the #HappyDoll in person and took pictures with them. I also read out the message in the card personally to them expressing my thanks and positive feelings for the association.

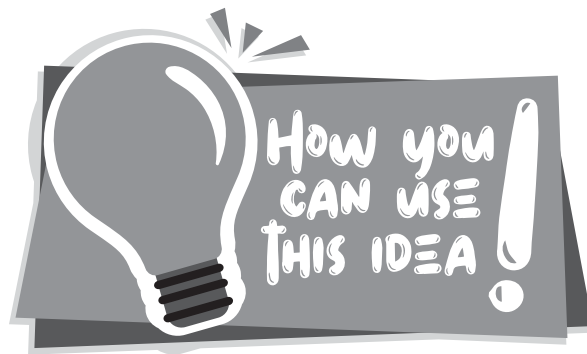
I edited the pictures we had taken and sent them to they could be posted on their timelines as well. This increased the reach automatically, and impressed an audience manifold of what we had already anticipated.

But it had one more effect: on that day, my timeline was filled with the hashtag #HappyDolls, and the corresponding message. My friends had their own followers who also interacted on this campaign and it became a big hit, marketing angle-wise but also in spreading happiness and positivity.

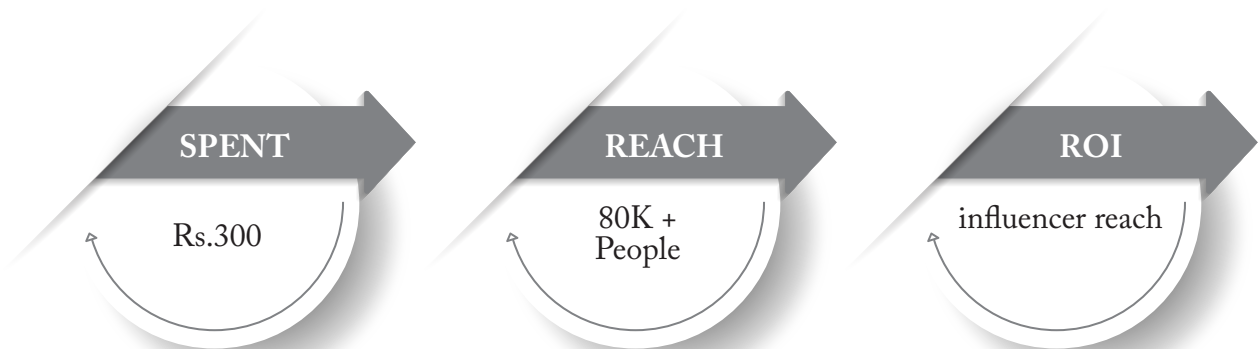
The above is just an example of how a negative story was converted into one with positive connotations for our brand, the6.in.

All we have to do is wait for the inspiration.

And when that happens, without spending much, money wise, you can reach more people and spread a positive message alongside your brand identity.



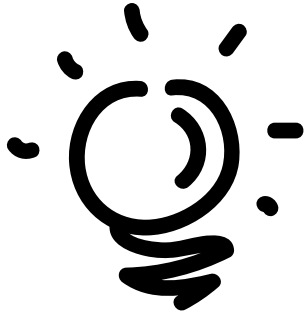
If you are participating in an expo, what can you do differently to pull the crowd at less cost ?



5

UPCYCLING
-- BANNERS TO TENTS





MYTH #5 GUERRILLA MARKETING CANNOT HELP OTHERS!

Bharathi Homes is a well-known builder in Chennai. They approached us for a unique marketing campaign with a different reach, and we thought of introducing guerrilla marketing to the brand, thereby taking it beyond the normal audience scope.

We discussed with the team and understood that they had flex banners that they used to promote their properties usually. These were previously used resources for regular marketing strategies, where banners are designed with the idea of advertising their company and brand.

We wanted to provide cost effective guerrilla marketing and we decided to reuse what was already available to create something unique out of our brains. We went back and worked on the story. After some brainstorming we decided to use the same flex banners they had designed, and create tents for them.

The idea was to provide these tents to the homeless people living on the streets.

The concept was that they could use these tents to sleep in, at nights when they needed a little more protection from the direct rain and during days when they needed some respite from the sun. This would help them have some structure to ease their lives and improve their living conditions, but it would also create more avenues for the brand of Bharathi Homes to be recognised everywhere.

The number of homeless people in the city, with many of them sporting tents which are made out of used flex banners consisting of the brand's name is a different kind of advertisement that will surely stay in the minds of the people who notice them.

And that was how the idea took birth.

As with all guerrilla marketers, we now faced our real challenge.

The homeless people living on the streets do not have a permanent spot even, to call theirs. They have to keep moving around, and they would need to constantly be able to take their meagre belongings along with them. The tents could not be bulky or hard to erect.

So we brainstormed and decided to design tents that are portable, weigh less, and also can be assembled and dismantled easily. This would help the people take these wherever they go, thereby increasing the longevity of the product and the effectiveness of the campaign.

The tent was designed with tamper proof features and could be assembled in less than five minutes. It can also be taken down easily, and folded into a very small capacity to be taken around. We made 100+ such tents and delivered them across Chennai.

We got a very good response for this initiative, and from the people who received the tent. We spoke with them and spent time listening to their stories, refining our approach based on their valuable inputs. We loved the way they reacted, and we realised that with our simple outlier marketing idea we had essentially changed the lives of some people in a little way at least.

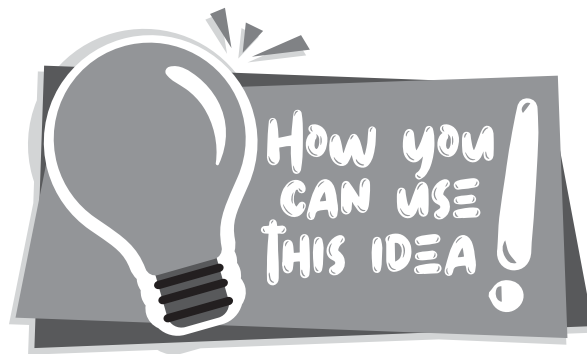
The next day saw some rains and we witnessed the people putting the tents we had given to good use. The marketing happened by itself, with the advertisement now reaching closer to the hearts of those who saw them, and noticed what we had used them for.

But more importantly, our idea sent a wave of happiness amidst lesser fortunate people, making them happier with something they could use to safeguard themselves from the ruthless elements of nature.

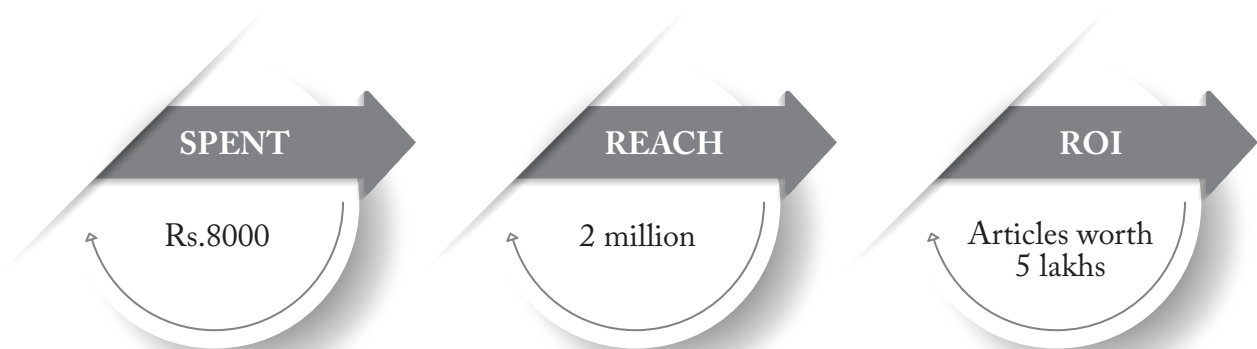
The news print and visual media quickly caught on and this story was featured in couple of Print Media. The story also got organic reach in social media, where a few popular pages shared the content and the pictures of the homeless people using the tents.

Our guerrilla marketing campaign won the hearts as much as it got the brand name across with people.

Many other brands came forward to offer their used flex banners later on for the construction of tents but the rains did not happen much after November 17 of that year so we had to wait to elaborate on the effectiveness of the same.



Is there a similar line of Cause that you can execute for a whole lot of audience ?

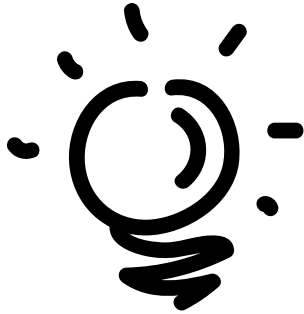


6



HAPPINESS EXPERIMENT





MYTH #6 GUERRILLA MARKETING CANNOT USE THE SURPRISE ELEMENT

The best of humanity is revealed by social experiments, and we at the6.in attempted something unique on the occasion of ‘World Happiness Day’. We embarked on this with one question: How do we spread happiness randomly?

To bring smiles on the faces of unknown people is the biggest gift to mankind, and we decided to do something that would make the day of shoppers at the Sri Venkateswara Supermarket. It was a joint initiative by folks at the supermarket and our team from the6.in.

Special thanks to the ever-smiling, friendly, Mr. Navin who participated in this experiment and chose to do sponsor his bit when he heard about our idea. This would not have been possible without the cooperation from the entire supermarket team.

The experiment was such: We chose the hours when the supermarket would be busy with shoppers. We had a small child stand in the billing queue with a chocolate bar that cost around 50 rupees. When the billers at the counter asked the child for the money, he would regretfully say that he does not have the entire amount, and fell short-changed by less than 10 rupees.

Anyone from the crowd behind him who intervened, noticing that the child wanted the chocolate for his sister, and offered to pay the extra amount of the child’s chocolate got the entire groceries they had billed for themselves for free. This experiment was a test on the generosity of human nature, and we wanted to see how many people actively participated and offered to help the child.

Our experiment bore fruit soon enough. While a few people were too busy to notice, or simply chose to move ahead without intervening, some paused, noticed the child, and offered to pay for the chocolate.

When this happened, the team from the supermarket informed them about the social experiment project and bagged their groceries for free. And for those who genuinely wanted to pay for the child to be a reason for his happiness instead were pleasantly surprised when their own groceries were packed for free.

The simple experiment was actually an outlier marketing idea that worked in favour of the6.in, with the entire team from the supermarket joining in and the video going viral on social media.

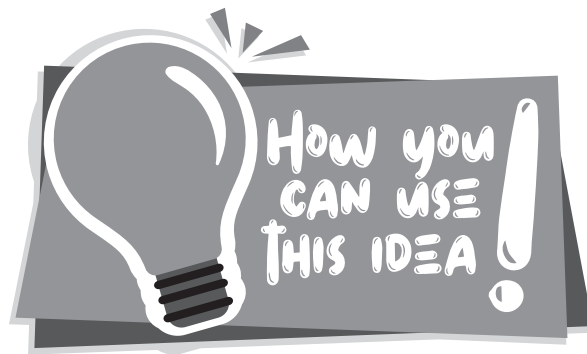
The concept of spreading happiness is something we give little thought to, on a day to day basis. But as a social experiment, those who wanted to bring a smile on the little child's face instead found themselves on the receiving end of a wonderful surprise that brought smiles to their faces.

A couple in particular, who were out on their first shopping evening together after their wedding, expressed their happiness at the surprise from the supermarket. It would be a memorable occasion for them, and a belated wedding gift.

Small acts of kindness spread better smiles than we imagine, and the results of the social experiment proved that people of all ages, young and old found joy when being surprised with a bag of free groceries. Kindness is always paid forward, and this social experiment proved that fact.

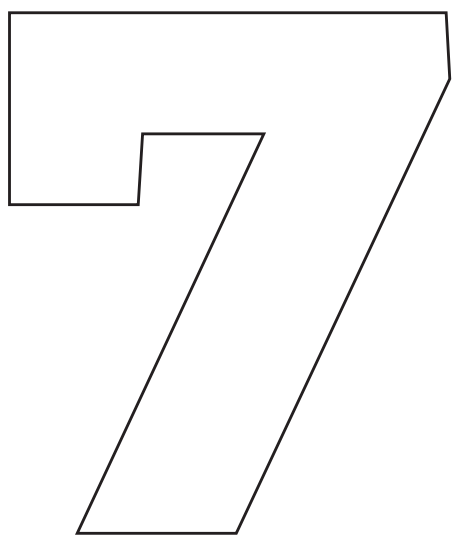
We at the6.in found ourselves appreciating the power of guerrilla marketing which was more about the brains behind the operation and the coordination between individuals to get a project to execute instead of spending much money on marketing.

In this particular instance, we would thank the people from the supermarket who chose to give away the groceries for the people who offered to pay, and the entire team who got this done without glitches. Perfection is a result of team work, and the6.in loved this chance to spread the message of happiness on the occasion of World Happiness Day.



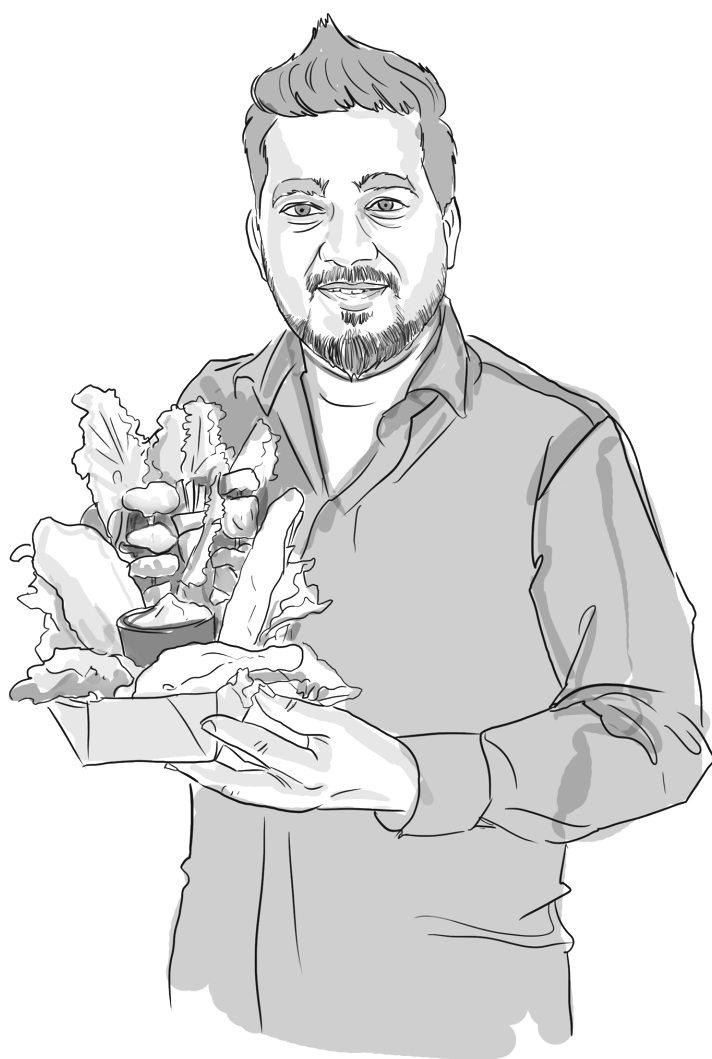
What are the special days that you can run a campaign.
I did a campaign on World Happiness day ?
What is your special day ?

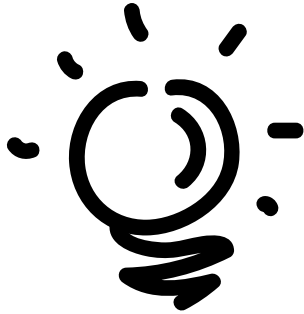






CHICKEN BOUQUET





MYTH #7 GUERRILLA MARKETING IS FOR STARTUPS

When you think of bouquets, the first things that come to mind are flowers. For a long time it has become synonymous with flowers to be made into expressive bouquets that are then gifted to loved ones for special days and even formal occasions.

But we at the6.in have always believed in doing things differently.

We have had many successful collaborations with famous brands, especially the original Thalapakatti Biryani restaurant chains. We have done few guerrilla marketing campaigns in association with them, and this was another wonderful, successful attempt.

On the occasion of Valentine's Day, we decided to do something unique in association with Thalapakatti that showcased our outlier marketing skills and also highlighted their speciality. The unique concept was to offer a bouquet of chicken pieces.

The chicken bouquet was an instant hit. Who would not like a bouquet made of edible food pieces of an item that they loved? It was a hit amongst couples and friends alike, for the concept of bouquets had suddenly gotten a new definition.

Instead of the usual, symbolic bunch of flowers, that could only be displayed and kept for decorative purposes, this chicken bouquet speciality was both an expression of love and also made of something everyone loved to have. The chicken bouquet appeared as a speciality item for Valentine's Day and within hours it became super hit

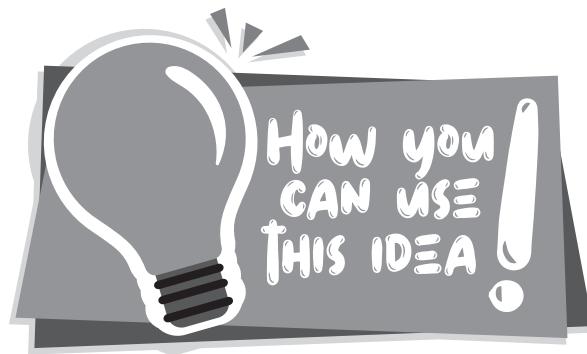
It was a cost effective marketing idea – because it was just a repurposing and rebranding of something that already existed with the menu in the restaurants. The existing chicken items were rearranged as a bouquet in specially made packages that had the restaurant branding.

Foodies, especially, loved the idea behind the different Valentine's Day gift, and this became even more popular than the usual flower bouquets that did not serve any other purpose rather than being simply decorative.

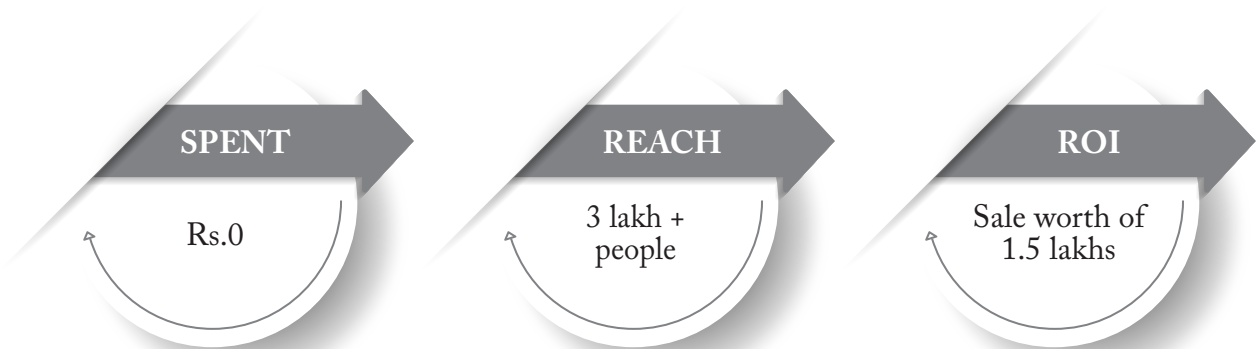
While some of our other marketing ideas were visibly focusing on getting the lesser brands across to people by creating an unique brand identity with low cost marketing ventures, this one was a different challenge, because we had to find out something unique on offer with an existing brand that was already famous for what it did.

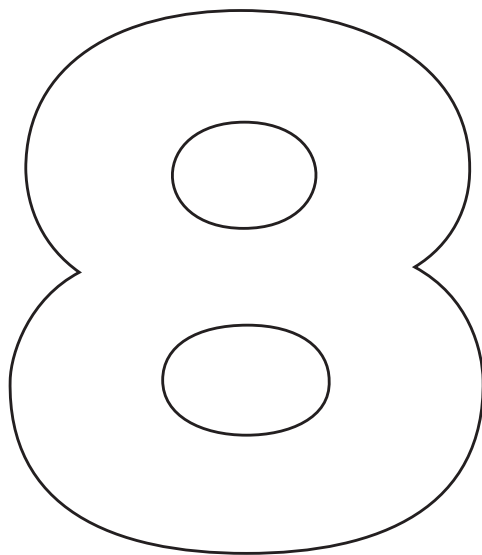
This particular idea from the6.in received a viral recognition on Facebook and other social media platforms, and the chicken bouquets were much more famous than the chicken buckets.

The artful arrangements, the presentation, and the famous dishes themselves were immediate points of attractions for the regular patrons of the restaurant who were looking for something different. This fit the bill and added value to the brand and became a success story for team of the6.in. Thalapakatti restaurants on the occasion of Valentine's Day. It became an immediate success.

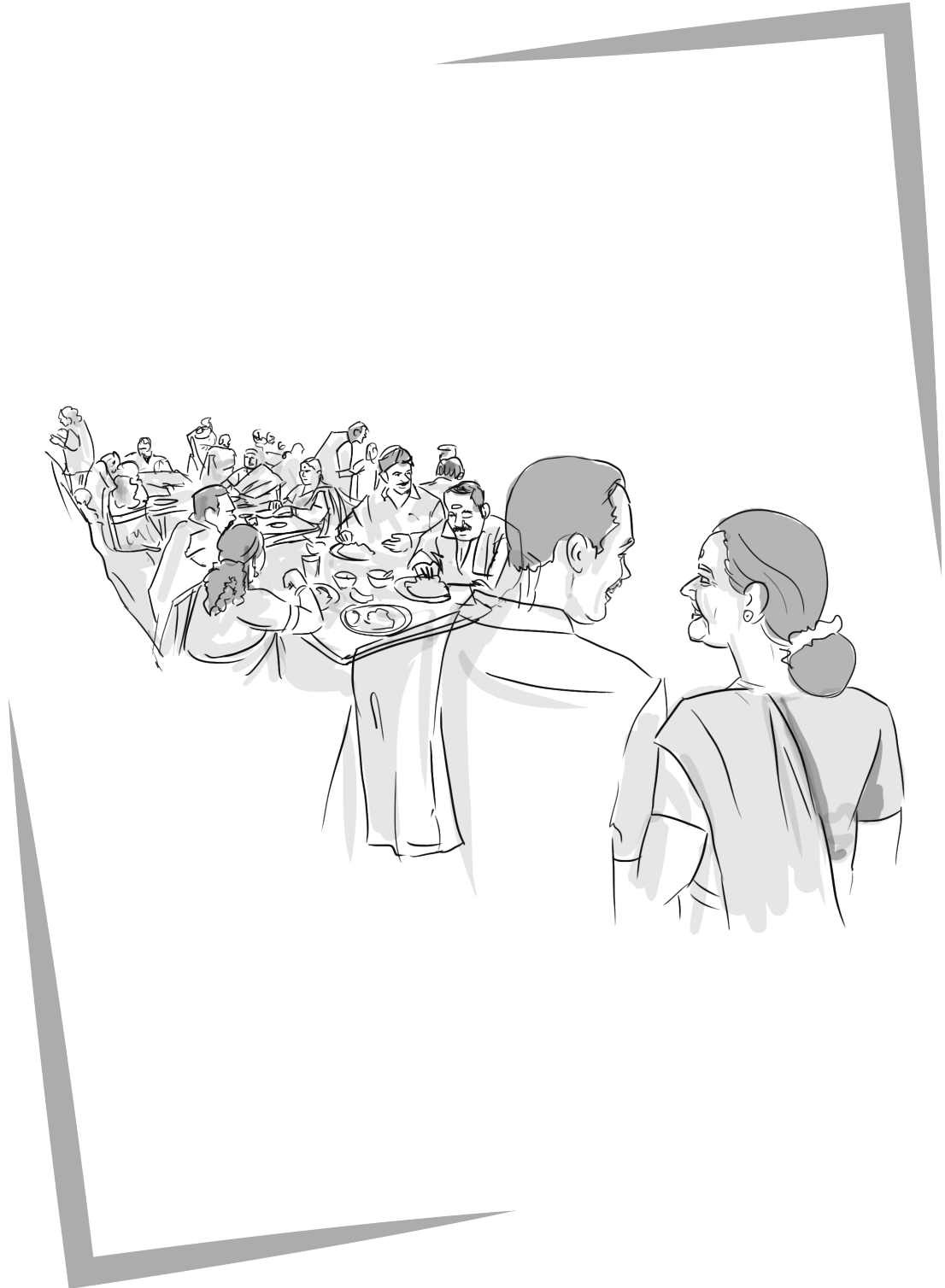


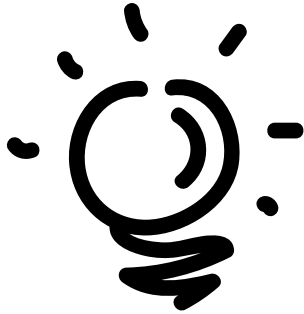
Re-purposing is the key here. How can you re-purpose your product or service and market it?





EXPERIMENT WITH
FARMERS





MYTH #8

CAN'T DO

SOCIAL

EXPERIMENTS

We were so worried for the Farmers protest was happening few years back. and wanted to something for them.

It was with this idea in mind that we from the6.in decided to perform another social experiment of sorts in collaboration with Hotel Prasan Sandeepha, situated in Madipakkam, Chennai.

When people think of the source of food, their thoughts usually stop at their nearest, or most convenient grocery store. And their choices end with the simple 'which variety of rice/lentils is the tastiest and most economical maybe?'

How often do we think of where food actually originates? About how it has to be farmed, grown, taken care of like a child until it is harvested, and then stored, and finally sold wholesale before it reaches the local grocery stores in fancy packages?

When you go to a hotel, your concentration is simply on the various items listed in the menu, and how they are presented/priced. What would happen if one day, you walk into a hotel, to see an actual farmer who has taken part in the process of manually growing the rice you eat?

When we approached Hotel Prasan Sandeepha with this guerrilla marketing idea, it was with good grace that the owners themselves agreed to take part in this. They even organised a scheme where 5 percent from the proceeds of their bills for a day would go to a family of farmers who were in need of help.

Whenever we hear stories of farmers that come to us via the news media, we only hear tales of sadness, loans, drought, flooding, suicides, mass deaths due to famine, and a complete lack of support or value worthiness for their goods that take weeks and months to produce.

Why not approach the same farmers as people, and show the other side of farming, that of bounty, growth and the struggles that bear fruit?

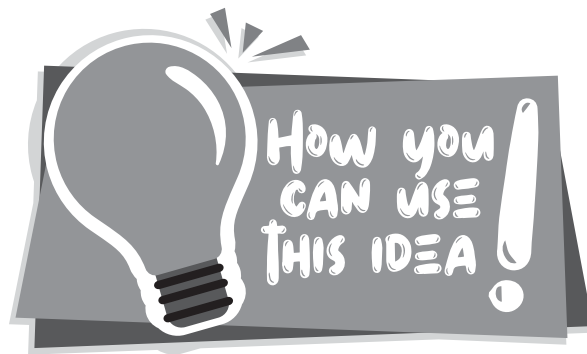
The team from the6.in explained this angle of farmers and farming to the patrons of the restaurant. We explained how farmers are not synonymous with only deaths and droughts, but are also the greatest inspirations and the backbones of the food production chain in this country.

The idea was simple: if the patrons were interested, we had a family of farmers brought in to explain their side of the story, and why it matters to have the proceeds from the bill go to them, and how much it would help them invest in farming, not to mention bettering their livelihood.

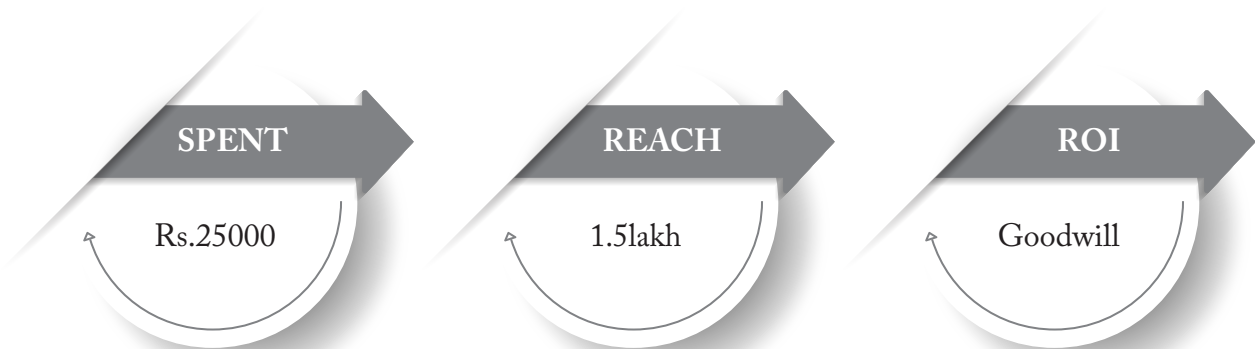
This cost effective outlier marketing idea brought a realisation for us: No matter how city-bred people seem, some of us do not forget our roots and where we began. It was with such high emotions that we witnessed a family of patrons actually relating with the farmers who had explained their story, getting emotional and praising their efforts, remembering their own times as farmers in the villages before they migrated.

Watering the roots was a simple exercise that showed us that just one generation ago we were a land of farmers, and we still have that inside our hearts and souls. While our minds have gone in search of more lucrative or profitable works, every man and woman of this land would feel connected to the simple pleasure of their foot on the farmlands' wet earth.

This cause was close to our heart, and to see our farmers treated with respect bordering on veneration by the patrons of the restaurant gave us the necessary boost and the belief that it takes very little for us to reclaim our heritage and culture, for it lurks just under the surface. An overall emotional moment that showed the power of touching on one's ancestry.



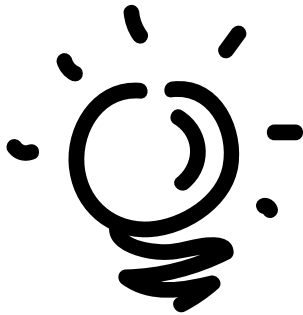
What is the one social experiment the resonate resonated with your business? Are you into retail, what is the one experiment that you can incorporate ?



9

**SUPERSTAR DRIVERS
- CELEBRATING THE
UNNOTICED**



**MYTH #9****BRAND RECALL****VIA GUERRILA****MARKETING****IS NOT REQUIRED****FOR BIGGER BRANDS**

For every safe journey we undertake, we never think of the people who are responsible for us reaching our destination safely. They are the first to be blamed even if anything minor goes wrong, but they remain largely unnoticed when things go right.

And we at the6.in decided to do something about it. When representatives from the famous ticket booking app, RedBus reached out to us for an innovative way to thank their bus drivers, we got to it with gusto, planning an elaborate surprise for the usually unnoticed people.

In one of our first guerrilla marketing collaborations, we decided to popularise the brand while spreading happiness in the same move. We chose the idea of a simple gift that would tell them how much they are celebrated, with a simple gesture.

We approached the bus drivers as part of the campaign, and offered them sunglasses and badges. They were happy to receive branded sunglasses that too in appreciation of their services, and the drivers also got a Thank You badge that we presented to them along with the people from RedBus.

The smiles we got in response were enough proof that the simple act of celebrating drivers made them feel special and realise that we were also thinking of them and their inimitable services in ferrying hundreds of passengers safely across the road every single day.

This was one of the best examples of outlier marketing that used a unique technique to get across the name of the brand while still being something that made the receivers happy. The dual purpose was served in the way we branded the gifts with that of the sponsors, and presented them to the deserving bus drivers who would use it proudly.

Our first collaborative guerrilla marketing venture was a success, mainly because it used cost effective marketing ideas to achieve the desired effect. The idea behind the marketing is what made it stand apart.

We also made a video of us presenting the gifts to the individual drivers, and asked them for their opinions. It was a rare chance to look into the lives of the individual drivers and hear about their problems and the difficulties they face while driving us in safety.

It was a great experience to learn about the drivers and their issues – something we had not given much thought to. After this marketing campaign we look at buses and our road travel with an entirely different light, noticing the efforts put in by people to drive with many restrictions.

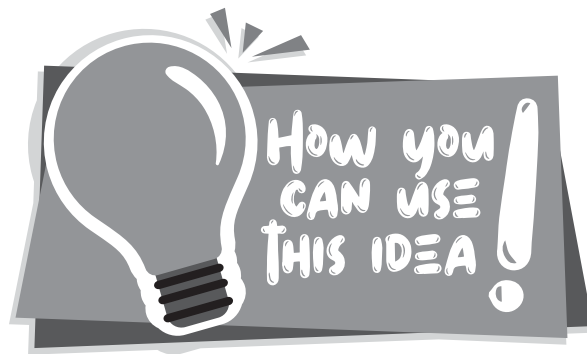
Reaching on time, doing it safely, and all the night journeys in less than favourable conditions makes the bus drivers practically superheroes who make this world a better place by their presence.

So it was only natural that with our guerrilla marketing efforts we thought of doing something for them that is both memorable and showing our gratefulness for these unsung heroes.

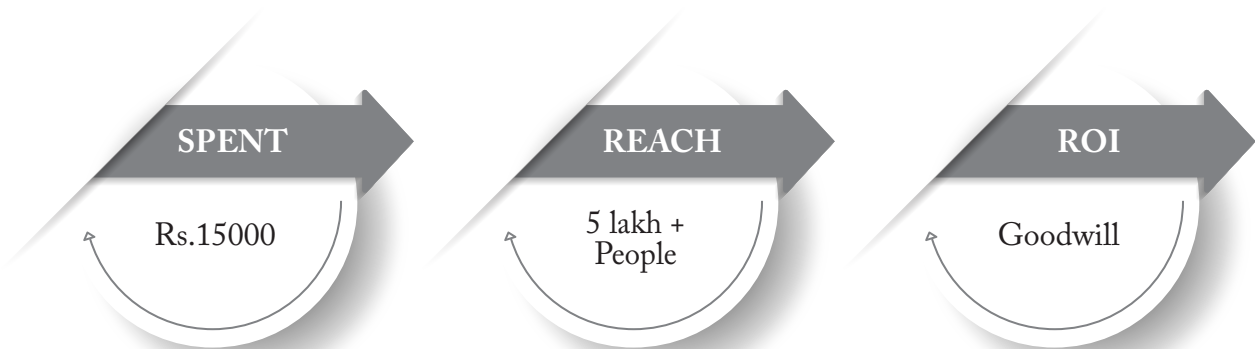
With this venture in partnership with RedBus we realised that the marketing is not only about getting the name of the brand across effectively but also in a way that will make the people involved remember the name of the brand with an affection.

What stood out in the entire exercise was the expression of thankfulness from the drivers, and their happiness that finally someone was doing something for them when they had long spent days being unseen and even ignored in places simply because they were considered to be doing their duty.

We at the6.in realised how important it was for us to use our chances to thank the people who mattered, and we were glad for this opportunity in partnership with the popular booking app, RedBus.



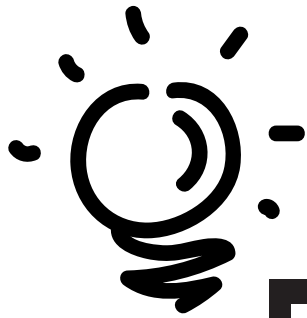
How can you make your customer recall your brand name at less cost or no cost?



10

**ELECTION CAMPAIGN &
ANTIBIOTIC-FREE CHICKEN**





MYTH #10 RANDOM IDEAS CAN'T BE IMPLEMENTED IN GUERRILLA MARKETING

Social responsibilities are common for everyone, and not limited to individuals or specific collective societies. A brand's presence in the market is not only about the quality of its product or service, but also of how it gels well as a part of the society in which it operates.

The marketing campaigns that focus on advertising the qualities of a product or service have a specific reach for the target demographic of those people who would benefit from the said things. But when any brand operates with a social responsibility, the scope and reach vary, expanding to a much wider audience, thereby acquiring what is considered the most important thing for any brand – recognition and a positive feeling towards them and their initiatives.

Tender Cuts is a chain of stores that have revolutionised the availability of good quality fresh meat and fish. Few months back they engaged the public in an initiative that was as much about social responsibility as it was about propagating something they felt passionate about.

#TN100%VOTE was a campaign organised by TenderCuts that aimed for 100 % vote turnouts in the General Elections that happened during April 2019. People from Tender Cuts paraded the streets of Chennai, handing out pamphlets to the public and insisting about the importance of casting one's vote and exercising our civil rights as an Indian citizen.

The largescale impact of this initiative was evident in the way people responded. Most of the audience who were approached responded positively, insisting with conviction that they would actively take part in the elections, performing their duty and voting in the elections.

To offer further incentives, Tender Cuts offered a 10% discount to those who entered their stores and showed their inked fingers. This ensured that those who voted would be rewarded with a considerable discount.

This outlier marketing idea worked as a combination of bringing in more business and also making the brand stand in the minds of patrons as someone with a civic sense.

The focus of the whole campaign was on getting people to vote, with the brand itself taking the backseat. In this way, the intended effect was multiplied manifold, as people stopped to take notice. And when that happened, they noticed the name behind the entire campaign. As far as the marketing angle was concerned, the initiative stood out.

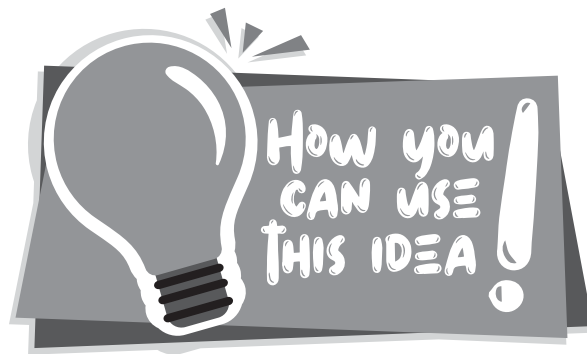
Guerrilla marketing is that type of roundabout approach that focuses on the outcome with unique ideas. The main focus of such campaigns should be to spread the name of the brand, and the idea becomes the tool with which the advertising is done indirectly.

Instead of looking at direct charts and reports of the resources invested in marketing ventures and measuring their success by the outcome, this type of marketing focuses on many things at once: brand building, generating interest on the brand (or its product or service), and also staying in the memory of target audience amidst heavy competition.

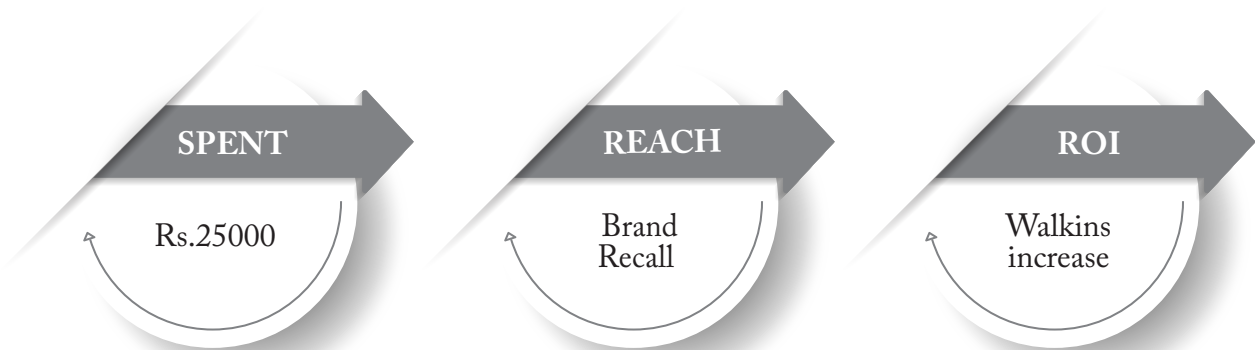
In this particular Tender Cuts venture, the cause was one of the most important government events ever – the National General Elections, and with that as the timing, the brand planned their initiative with care, so it would be rewarding for people who chose to do their duty, and also incentivise those who were cats on the wall.

The effect of course, was to motivate people to vote, but the subtext was the broader perspective of marketing – that to make people associate the brand with such a novel initiative. It is such campaigning that takes the name of the brand among masses in their regular conversations, instead of visual and print media advertisements that merely are prepared material.

The campaign got good organic reach on social media platforms, furthering the fame of Tender Cuts.



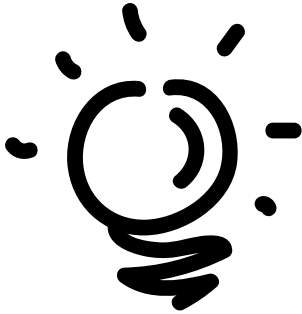
Take a newspaper or a magazine, see a random word & create an idea with reference to the word & to your brand, You will be amazed with what the thoughts could bring.



11

DEMONETISATION
QUEUE
&
TEA





MYTH #11

BRANDS CAN'T

COLLABORATE

IN A GUERRILLA

MARKETING

CAMPAIGN .

Let us begin with demonetisation, which was the process where the currency notes that were in circulation were devalued and rescinded, only to be replaced with newer currency notes in same and even different denominations. This happened few years ago, when our honorable prime minister Mr. Narendra Modi announced its implementation on 8th November 2016.

When everyone was busy in criticism and politics there were some unsung warriors helping the public and pulling them out of this difficult situation.

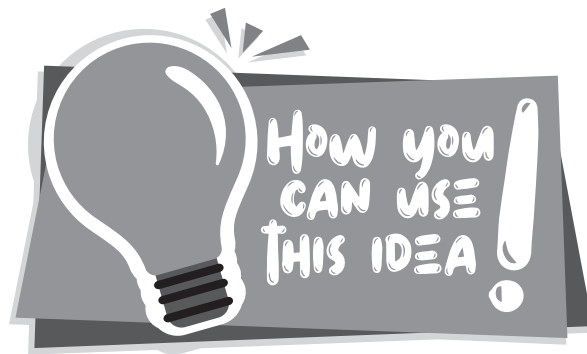
In the immediate aftermath of the demonetisation announcement, standing in the long and never-ending queue was the hardest nut to crack for every Indian. And in the times of exhaustion and concern, if you get anything for refreshment you will feel obliged for the server of that refreshment.

We got an idea. What if we surprised the people standing in the queue with a hot beverage? We approached Chaikanth for this campaign and they readily agreed to join us!

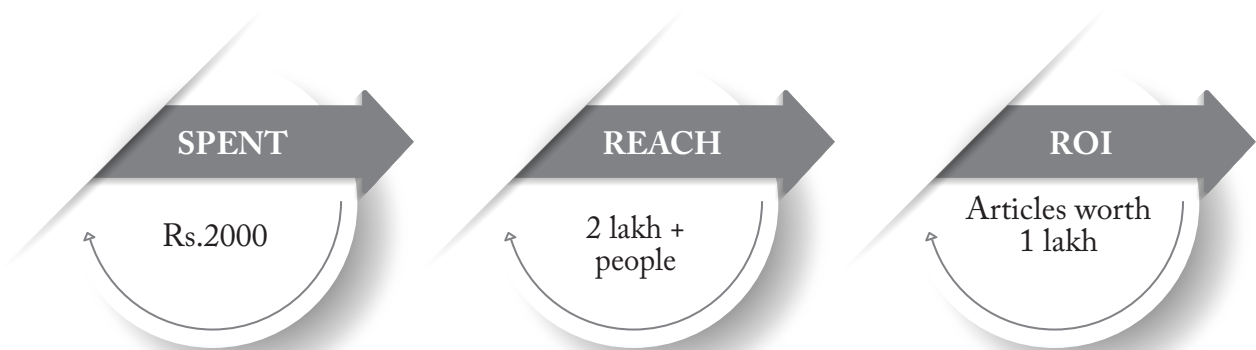
We hired 2 female promoters - they wore Chaikanth t-shirts & carried tea flasks along with them, and delivered tea to the people standing in the queue.

This togetherness of brands for serving people with free cup of tea resulted in the publicity of the venture. Their video of supplying tea to people in need reached people.

Facebook pages covered the whole story of us giving tea to people who waited long hours in front of ATMs. The major point to be noted is, their efforts to serve people with a cup of tea went viral without any paid promotion. Not a single penny was spent in this promotion so it got popular at a prominent level in a very organic way. This is what defines guerrilla marketing in the most efficient manner.



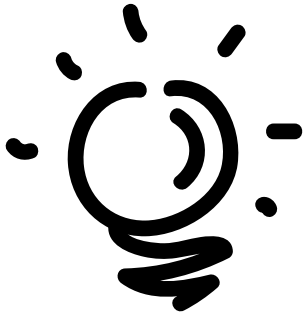
Which brand can you collaborate with?
If you are running a restaurant can you do a
campaign with a FMCG brand ?



12

UPCYCLING
- BANNERS TO RAINCOATS.





MYTH #12

GUERRILLA

MARKETING

CANNOT USE

SIMILAR PRACTICES

WITH DIFFERENT

BRANDS

Our previous campaign of converting flex banners to tents was super hit. People living on the roadside put it to use. One thing we observed was, they used it only when they rested. We thought, why don't we do something with the banners that they could use when they were working as well?.

Most of the people working on the roadside may not have an umbrella or a raincoat. We also got a great response for the tent video and many event managers offered us to give the used flex banners.

But unfortunately the rains had stopped and summer began. After an year when the rainy season came again, we pitched the concept to M-auto. They readily agreed to execute the plan for security personnel & auto drivers.

We then designed the rain coat in such a way that it is easy to use and the execution cost was less. We came up with an idea of just using velcro and stapled the ends. The total cost of making the rain coat was less than Rs.30.

We then discussed the concept & explained the design to the brand & they approved the process. We shared the design & the process. In 2 days the drivers were able to make 100+ raincoats. We then went out and distributed the raincoat to auto drivers and roadside vendors

The drivers were so happy that they did this for a cause. It was an awesome feel when the security people thanked us. One of the roadside vendors immediately used the rain coat & did the service. He offered tender coconut as a gesture to thank us. We were excited & felt emotional at the same time.

We made a video & posted it online. We asked if we can get more banners. We got a call from one actor's fan club & they said they wanted to execute the same. We got excited & we readily trained them in the process. We helped them to do first few raincoats & they themselves called their fellow friends from the club & processed around 100+ raincoats.

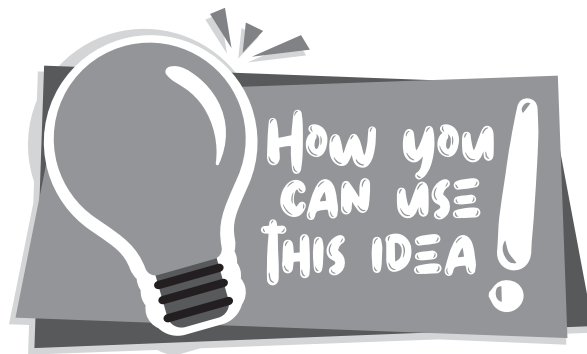
They delivered the raincoats to the people on the roadside.

This video was also posted online, the actor himself retweeted it and thanked the fans.

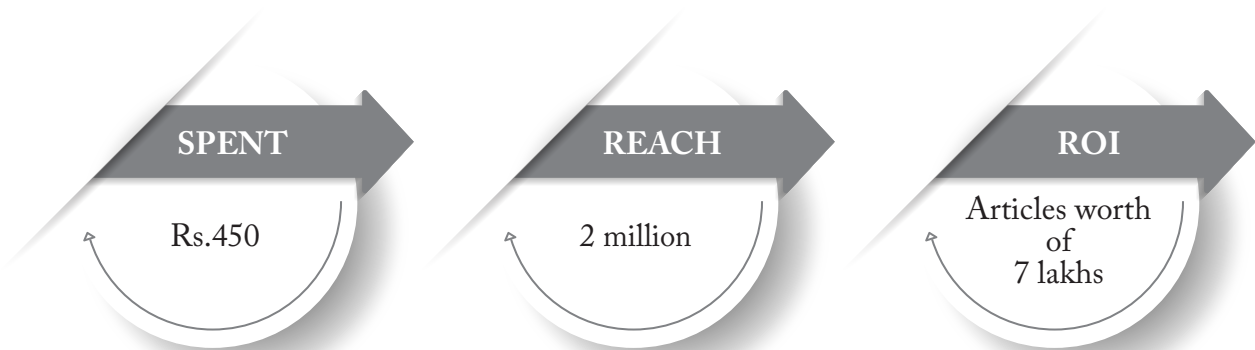
After the government banned the banners, we upcycled the used banners and the idea went viral.

The story got greater reach when a couple of newspapers covered the story. One TV channel featured the entire campaign.

The money spent was very less and, in turn the reach was 100x the value that they had spent.



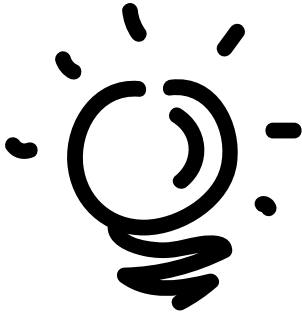
If you are running a salon can you have a series of campaigns with one agenda?
What is that ?



13

BIRYANI
IS
BAE.





MYTH #13 GUERRILLA MARKETING CANNOT WORK WITH REPURPOSING

What do you do differently for you to stand out? If you are running a restaurant what will you do for valentines day? You may offer special discounts for couples, decorate the restaurant romantically with red roses & hearts. Curate a candle light dinner with bands performing? You will wait for the customers to come with a tough competition? With the increase in competition & with the entry of delivery apps it is always tough to stand out as a brand.

Madras Biryani thought outside the box for Valentines day. They offered free Biryani for Singles.

The Single boys & girls have to come to the restaurant & prove themselves as singles to avail this offer. The campaign was strategically placed so that it goes viral prior to D-Day.

The campaign was called Biryani is Bae.

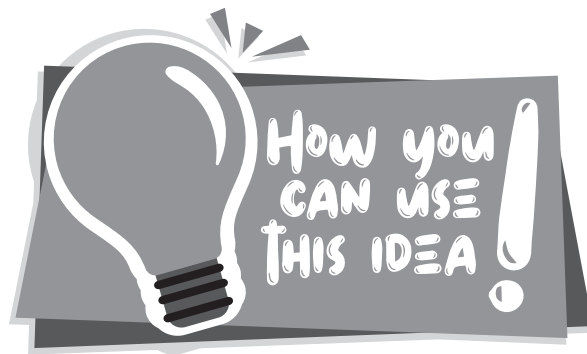
We also tried a different marketing campaign, we created memes & posted in one of the famous meme pages. The campaign was an immediate success as everyone started to tag their gang of friends who were singles. The comments were flooded with 'single pasanga' gangs.

On Valentines day when most of the restaurants were expecting couples, we were geared to welcome Singles.

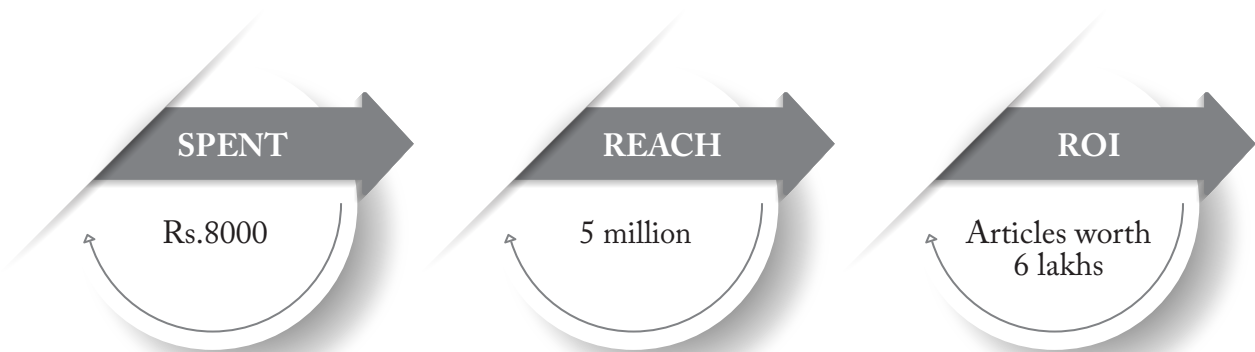
When most of the restaurants were trying to make business, we were offering Free Biryani. At around 3:15 PM, there was a huge crowd in front of the restaurant. The singles had to take a selfie with an Instagram board & had to upload it in their profile tagging the restaurant. Though we were offering only 50 biryanis, 100+ people flooded the restaurant.

With the social media posts, a couple of TV channels came in, to shoot the story. In all these years of restaurant business, of all the Valentine's Day celebrations, that was the first time a campaign was targeted towards singles on Valentine's Day. Soon it became a sensation in social media. Many blogs covered the story. Few articles got featured online.

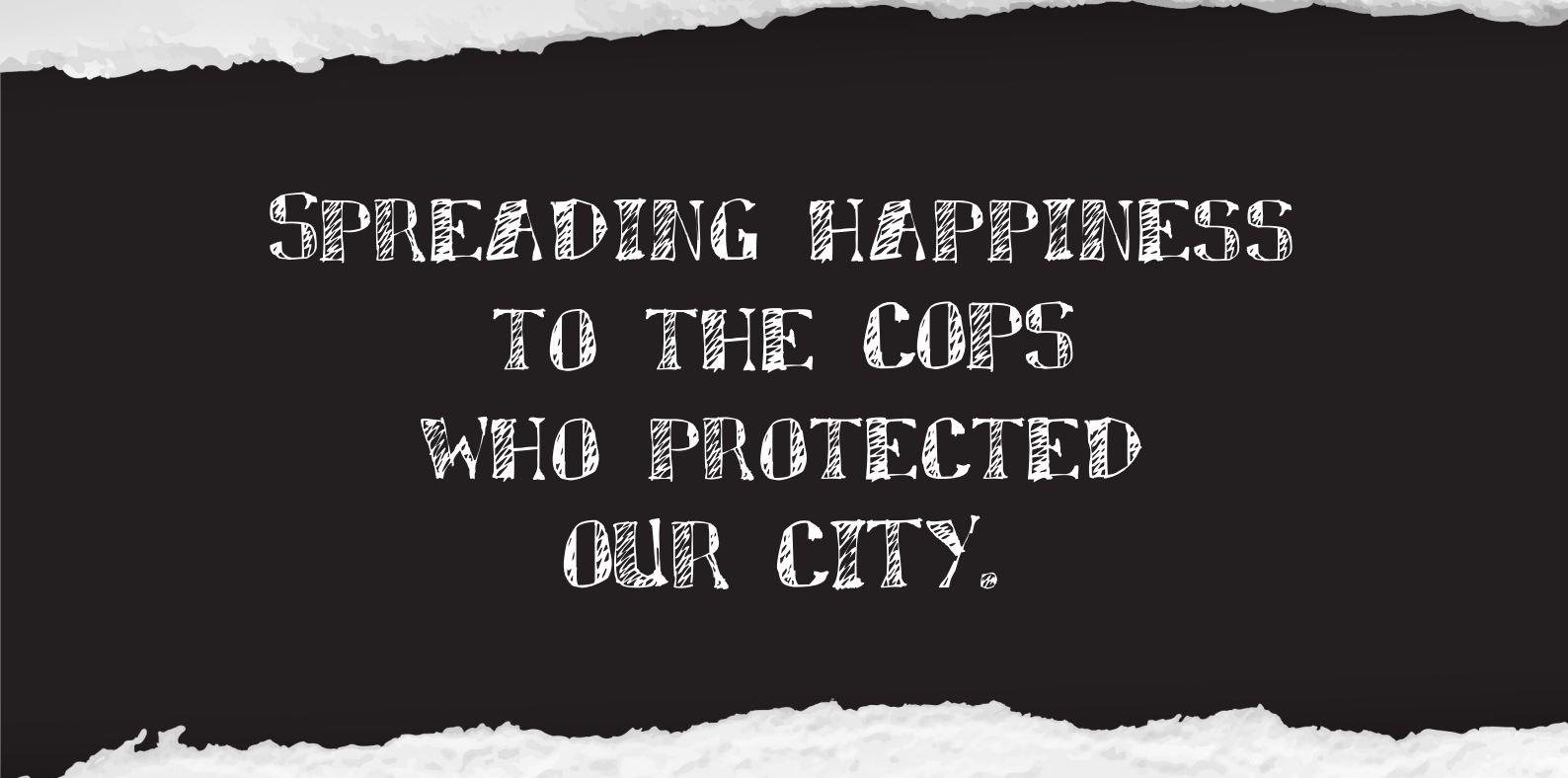
The next day radio channels also covered the campaign. Many people came to know about the brand at a very less cost.



What is the one idea that you go opposite of what you do ?

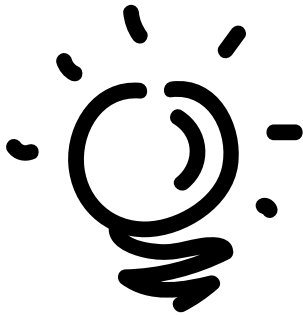


14



SPREADING HAPPINESS
TO THE COPS
WHO PROTECTED
OUR CITY.





MYTH #14

DON'T NEED

A MYTH

TO WRITE

ABOUT THIS

TOPIC

The entire State of Tamil Nadu, and even the country cannot forget the untimely demise of the late Chief Minister, J Jayalalithaa. She suffered a prolonged illness from which she never recovered, and the State was in a state of readiness for news of any kind for weeks before the actual announcement came about the passing.

A few weeks before she passed away, we were expecting widespread agitation and riots all over the state that, we felt, were bound to happen in mourning. But when the announcement came that the Chief Minister is no more, the scene was so quiet and the State of Tamil Nadu so dignified in the mourning.

But the crowds were enormous, and the work behind the scenes was also great. Two days later, pictures of police personnel sleeping on the road, eating near toilets, standing day and night surfaced on social media. One of my friends shared the pics with me and requested us to do something for them.

Moved by the sacrifice of these people in trying to do their job, we decided to do some surprise planning to spread a little cheer.

At around 8 AM, I called Snackexperts and requested them to provide snack pouches for the police. And the famous CakeSquare shops offered cakes for us. We got some volunteers from the Bhumi Trust, and began work.

First, we printed cards that said, 'Keep Calm & Respect the Police'. We reached the Marina Beach around 5 PM, and started executing our plan. We walked up to the police standing there and offered the snack pouches and the card. For a moment, they were taken aback because this was a unique gesture. But soon, they smiled and thanked us.

A few metres away, around ten policemen were standing and monitoring the proceedings. I walked up to them, and the policemen started asking questions about what we were doing. I smiled, gave them the card that we had printed, and offered the snack pouches. Along with it, I told them that the city was safe because of the police force.

We then went to the Kotturpuram Police Station and offered the snacks to the policemen and women there. One of them told that this was the first time someone had ever walked into the Station to thank them. It was such an experience for us, to hear the surprised thankfulness in their voices. It was also an emotional moment for me to see the policemen moved by our gesture.

The portrayals about the police force were smashed that day, as we celebrated their long and selfless service, and they were surprised and responded with politeness and thankfulness.

The videos taken of our interactions with the police were uploaded on social media around 1 AM, and the next morning, it had 1 million views. The video had gone viral, over all platforms on social media. There were WhatsApp forwards happening, and many had started to share it via Facebook and other platforms, thereby taking our initiative to the masses.

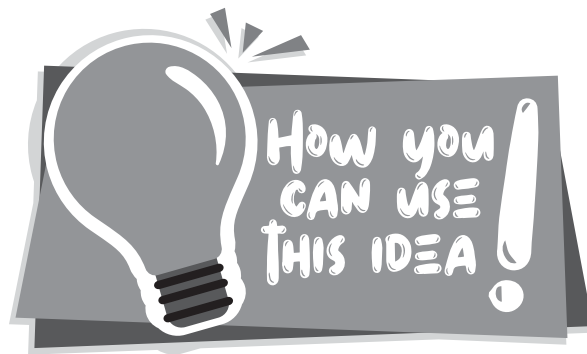
The next week, an NGO organised a #ThankingPolice initiative and invited us. We went to 6+ Police Stations and wished each and every one working there. One of the policewomen explained about how she was managing her family and was also out the whole day safeguarding the city. We marvelled at the dedication shown by the police force in keeping law and order in the state at the cost of risk to their personal lives.

The videos we had taken at the Stations went viral and many of the meme pages also shared about our initiative, lauding what we had done. This was a case of Surprise Planning becoming a Spreading Happiness thing, and in its own way, it was guerrilla marketing at its finest, for it took the name of our brand beyond the normal scope and made it reach the common people.

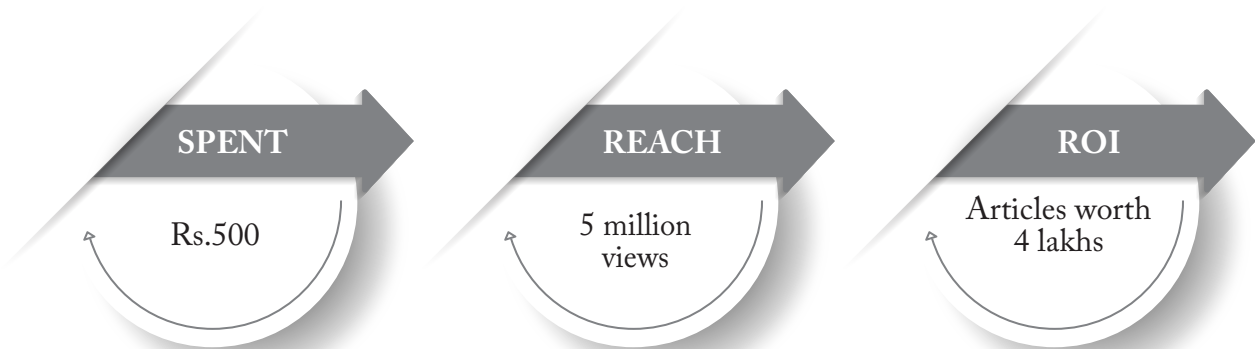
Not to mention that the actual costs behind this initiative were one of the lowest, making this a fine example of cost effective marketing.

Brand recognition is what we got out of this curation. From Surprise Planners we became a brand that does anything to make someone happy.

Brand recognition is the extent to which a consumer can correctly identify a particular product or service just by viewing the product or service's logo, tag line, packaging or advertising campaign



Observe the moment as a marketer and think of the random thought that you can market.



"Ninjas" Stun underprivileged with gifts and gimmicks
- **DTNEXT**

*"The6.in, A surprise planning company and a construction company
have come together to create dismantlable tents from flex boards.
They have distributed 115 units so far in various parts of chennai."*
- **TIMES OF INDIA**

"Winning with a vinyl solution"
- **NEW INDIAN EXPRESS**

*Sakthi is the son of a mill worker. He is the first in his family
to be educated. His first job was as an assistant laying cables with
a cable operator in Coimbatore, when he was 15 years old.*

*And now, he is stunning the city as a Chief Surprise Ninja,
spreading happiness with his wholesome projects.*

*He has also been an ardent Guerrilla Marketer for more
than 10 years now, changing the field with his innovative ideas
and quick thinking.*

